



Product Matters 6.0 · Week 1 Assignment

LinkedIn

Product Analysis Presentation

Proposed Feature Name: Application Closure & Feedback System (ACFS)

By Chhavi Tanwar



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01 PRODUCT OVERVIEW



Core Problem Solved

LinkedIn is a professional networking platform that helps users:

- Build professional identity
- Connect with professionals
- Discover jobs
- Recruit talent



Primary Users

Job Seekers · Recruiters · B2B Marketers · Professionals seeking networking, learning & brand visibility.



1B+

Members Worldwide



67M+

Companies Listed



#1

Professional Network



Value Created

For Job Seekers: Visibility to recruiters, easy apply, skill showcasing. **For Recruiters:** AI-powered talent sourcing, applicant filtering.
For Businesses: Brand building, B2B lead generation, employee advocacy.



Verdict: LinkedIn is firmly in the MATURITY stage of the Product Life Cycle

Introduction

2003–2006
Early adopters,
slow growth

Growth

2007–2016
Rapid user & revenue
expansion

Maturity

2017–Present
Dominant but
stable growth

Decline

Not yet –
but risk exists if
stagnation continues

◀ NOW

Supporting Evidence

- Revenue ~\$15B (2023), growing but at a slower pace than Growth phase - classic Maturity signal.
- Microsoft acquired LinkedIn for \$26.2B in 2016 - typical of a Maturity-stage asset with proven monetization.
- Core features (jobs, feed, messaging) are stable. Innovation is incremental (AI tools, Learning Hub).
- Competition from Naukri (India), Glassdoor, and Twitter/X for professional discourse signals saturation.
- Retention tactics (notifications, LinkedIn Premium nudges) indicate platform prioritising stickiness over growth.

03 USER PERSONA



Abhishek Sharma

Occupation: Final-year engineering student

Location: Kanpur, India

Age: 21



Tech / Engineering



Mobile-first user

Goals

- Land a product/tech role before graduation
- Build professional network proactively
- Get noticed by FAANG & product-led companies

Frustrations

- Applies to 50+ roles - hears back from <10%
- No closure: applications stay 'Under Review' forever
- Recruiter visits profile but never responds

Motivations

- Career advancement & financial independence
- Peer validation (everyone is applying)
- LinkedIn Premium promises 'InMail' access to recruiters

Key Needs

- Transparency on application status
- Timely feedback/rejection (closure matters!)
- Fair shot - not lost in a pile of 500 applicants



04 USER FLOW – Applying for a Job on LinkedIn



Critical friction: Steps 5 & 6 are broken. After submission, users enter a black box - no SLA, no feedback loop, no accountability for recruiters.

Happy Path →

Search → Apply → Get shortlisted → Interview → Offer

Most Common Path (Reality) → Search → Apply → Under Review (forever) → Ghost → Re-apply elsewhere

Premium User Path →

Pay for InMail → Reach recruiter → Still get ignored 60% of the time



05 PRODUCT CRITIQUE



What Works Well

- ✓ Easy Apply reduces application friction significantly.
- ✓ Recruiter visibility into applicant profiles builds context.
- ✓ Skills Assessments add credibility to profiles.
- ✓ Job Alerts & Saved Searches improve discovery.
- ✓ LinkedIn Learning integration for upskilling is well-placed.



What Doesn't Work

- X Zero accountability for recruiters after listing a job.
- X Application status stuck on 'Viewed' / 'Under Review' indefinitely.
- X No notification when a listing expires: the applicant is just ghosted.
- X Easy Apply allows bulk-applying; quality → volume mismatch.
- X Premium paywalls often fail to deliver on their promises.



THE CORE PAIN POINT: Application Ghosting

When a job listing expires, applicants receive zero notification. Their CVs are effectively buried. Recruiters face no SLA or accountability to review submissions - a structural gap that erodes user trust and platform stickiness.



Missed Opportunity:

LinkedIn could enforce a Review Deadline mechanism - giving recruiters a firm window to screen applications post-expiry, and notifying candidates automatically. This converts a frustrating dead-end into a moment of trust-building.



06 FEATURE PROPOSAL : “ Application Closure & Feedback System” (ACFS)

When a job listing closes, recruiters must review applications within 7 days - or applicants automatically receive a 'Not Proceeding' notification with dignity.

A

Listing Expires

Job posting closes naturally or manually.
Timer starts: T+0

B

Recruiter Review Window

7-day SLA enforced. Recruiter sees
countdown badge in dashboard.

C

Review or Auto-Close

Recruiter marks: Shortlisted / Rejected. If
no action → auto-close triggers.

D

Candidate Notified

Email + in-app: 'Application reviewed. Not
proceeding at this time.' - with option to
save profile.

First Principles Thinking

Core assumption stripped: "Recruiter reviewing applicants is optional."

First Principle: A job listing is a contract - the employer seeks, the seeker applies. Both parties deserve a resolution.

Solution: Enforce minimum accountability via deadline, not reliance on recruiter goodwill.

Feature Details & Guardrails

- Recruiter sets review window (3/7/14 days) when posting.
- Dashboard badge shows countdown + pending review count.
- Recruiter can bulk-reject with one click (saves time).
- Opt-in for companies (incentivised with 'ACFS Compliant' badge).
- Candidates see the ACFS badge on listings → boosts application rate.



07 EXPECTED IMPACT

User Impact

- ✦ ↑ Trust & closure : users get definitive responses.
- ✦ ↓ Anxiety of indefinite 'Under Review' status.
- ✦ ↑ Re-engagement : users who get closure come back.
- ✦ ↑ Profile saves: rejected candidates remain in the recruiter pool.
- ✦ Better perceived fairness → ↑ NPS scores.

Business Impact

- ✦ ↑ Job seeker DAU / WAU : platform becomes trustworthy.
- ✦ ↑ Premium conversion: feature-gated fast-track reviews.
- ✦ ↑ Recruiter accountability → ↑ employer brand scores.
- ✦ Differentiation from Naukri / Glassdoor in India market.
- ✦ Regulatory readiness (EU & India labour law compliance).

Metrics to Track (Success Criteria)

ACFS Adoption Rate (recruiter opt-in %) | Time-to-resolution (avg days) | Candidate re-engagement rate post-ACFS | NPS delta (job seekers) | Premium upsell rate (ACFS-tier)

"A platform that respects the job seeker's time will earn their lifetime loyalty. ACFS is not just a feature - it's a trust contract."

LinkedIn

Software Engineer Intern
ABC Technologies

Location: Bangalore

Applications Close: 30 June 2026

[Apply Now]

Employer Responsiveness

● Highly Responsive Employer
Avg Response Time: 4 Days

Arrow to next screen →

Application Submitted ✓

Software Engineer Intern
ABC Technologies

Application ID: #LNKD-45782

Expected Review Timeline
Application Deadline: 30 June
Review Window: 1 July - 7 July
Status: Under Review

[View Application Status]

Arrow to next screen →

My Applications

Software Engineer Intern
ABC Technologies

Timeline

✓ Application Submitted 10 June
✓ Application Viewed 14 June
✓ Under Review 18 June

🕒 Final Decision Pending

Review Deadline 7 July 2026

Status: [Under Review]

Arrow to next screen →

Screen 4A: Recruiter Responds

Application Update

Software Engineer Intern

Status: ● Shortlisted

Next Step: Interview Round Scheduled

Date: 12 July

[View Details]

OR

Status: ● Not Selected

Thank you for applying.
We appreciate your interest.

Alternative branch →

Screen 4B: Recruiter Ghosts Applicants

Automatic Closure Notification

Software Engineer Intern
ABC Technologies

Review Deadline Reached

The employer has not provided an update regarding this position.
LinkedIn has automatically closed the application process.

Status:

● Closed Without Employer Response

[Explore Similar Jobs]